9TH GRADE WORLD HISTORY · 2026

Unit 5 Final Exam

WORLD WARS & AFTERMATH

STUDENT NAME

PERIOD

DATE

SCORE / 100

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully before answering.
2. For multiple choice, fill in the box next to your chosen answer completely.
3. For matching, write the letter of the matching definition on the line next to each term.
4. For short answer, write in complete sentences. Use specific evidence from the unit (names, dates, terms, events).
5. For the essay, choose one of the two prompts. Your essay must include a clear claim, at least three pieces of specific evidence, and reasoning that explains how your evidence proves your claim.
6. You have the full class period. Manage your time — the essay is worth 25 points and deserves real care.

SECTION	ITEMS	POINTS
A · Multiple Choice	25 questions	50
B · Matching (Key Terms)	10 items	10
C · Short Answer	3 questions	15
D · Essay (Synthesis)	1 essay (choice of 2 prompts)	25
TOTAL	**39 items**	**100**

— BEGIN EXAM ON NEXT PAGE —

A

Multiple Choice

25 ITEMS · 2 POINTS EACH · 50 PTS

> *Fill in the box next to the best answer for each question. Select only one answer per question.*

1. What does the acronym MAIN stand for in the context of WWI's causes?

- ☐ A. Monarchy, Armaments, Invasion, Nationalism
- ☐ B. Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, Nationalism
- ☐ C. Mobilization, Arms, Industry, Nationalism
- ☐ D. Militarism, Alliances, Industry, Nationalism

2. Militarism contributed to WWI by encouraging European nations to:

- ☐ A. Reduce their armies to save money for economic growth
- ☐ B. Build up armed forces, produce better weapons, and view military strength as a source of national power
- ☐ C. Form defensive alliances to prevent war through deterrence
- ☐ D. Colonize new territories to fund their armies

3. How did the alliance system in Europe make a small conflict more dangerous?

- ☐ A. Alliances allowed nations to negotiate peacefully before fighting
- ☐ B. Alliances created a chain reaction — when one country was attacked, its allies were pulled in, turning a local crisis into a world war
- ☐ C. Alliances gave smaller nations the ability to resist larger empires
- ☐ D. Alliances forced countries to share resources and avoid conflict

4. Extreme nationalism in pre-WWI Europe contributed to war by:

- ☐ A. Encouraging nations to form a unified European government
- ☐ B. Creating shared identity across different ethnic groups within empires
- ☐ C. Fueling rivalry between nations, ethnic tension, and independence movements that destabilized empires like Austria-Hungary
- ☐ D. Reducing competition because nations felt secure in their own identities

5. Archduke Franz Ferdinand was assassinated on June 28, 1914, in Sarajevo. Who killed him?

- [ ] A. A German spy, to give Germany an excuse to invade France
- [ ] B. An Austrian nationalist protesting the emperor's policies
- [ ] C. Gavrilo Princip, a Serbian nationalist — his death triggered the alliance chain reaction that escalated into WWI
- [ ] D. A British agent trying to prevent Austro-Hungarian expansion

6. Historians call the assassination of Franz Ferdinand the 'spark' rather than the 'cause' of WWI. What does this distinction mean?

- [ ] A. The assassination was entirely unrelated to the start of WWI
- [ ] B. The MAIN causes had already built an unstable system; the assassination triggered it — but the deeper forces were already in place
- [ ] C. The assassination directly and singlehandedly caused WWI with no other factors involved
- [ ] D. The 'cause' was actually the Treaty of Versailles signed before the war

7. What was the correct sequence of nations entering WWI after the assassination?

- [ ] A. Britain → France → Russia → Germany → Austria-Hungary
- [ ] B. Austria-Hungary attacked Serbia → Russia supported Serbia → Germany backed Austria-Hungary → France supported Russia → Britain entered after Germany violated Belgian neutrality
- [ ] C. Serbia attacked Austria-Hungary → Germany invaded France → Russia declared war on Britain
- [ ] D. Germany invaded Belgium → Britain attacked Austria-Hungary → Russia stayed neutral

8. Trench warfare developed in WWI primarily because:

- [ ] A. Generals on both sides were incompetent and refused to fight
- [ ] B. Industrialized weapons made open battlefield movement suicidal — soldiers dug in for protection because crossing open ground meant certain death
- [ ] C. Both sides ran out of ammunition too quickly to fight in the open
- [ ] D. The terrain in France was naturally full of trenches

9. Which of the following was NOT a weapon or technology that made WWI especially deadly?

- [ ] A. Machine guns
- [ ] B. Chemical weapons (poison gas)
- [ ] C. Nuclear bombs
- [ ] D. Heavy artillery

10. The Treaty of Versailles (1919) included all of the following EXCEPT:

- A. Germany accepting war guilt through the 'war guilt clause'
- B. Germany being required to pay approximately $33 billion in reparations
- C. Germany gaining new territories as compensation for wartime losses
- D. Germany facing strict military restrictions

11. How did industrialization connect to both the causes AND the conduct of WWI?

- A. Industrialization had no connection to how WWI was fought — it only affected economics
- B. Industrialization fueled militarism and competition (cause), and then produced the deadly weapons and technologies that made the war long and devastating (conduct)
- C. Industrialization prevented war by making nations economically dependent on each other
- D. Industrialization caused WWI by creating too many workers who needed wars for employment

12. Many historians argue that the Treaty of Versailles helped cause WWII. What is the core of that argument?

- A. The treaty gave Germany too much power, making it dangerous again
- B. By humiliating Germany with blame, crushing reparations, and military restrictions, the treaty created economic devastation and deep resentment that extremists like Hitler later exploited
- C. The treaty ignored Germany entirely, leaving a power vacuum in Europe
- D. The treaty was so generous that Germany felt strong enough to start another war immediately

13. What was the Weimar Republic, and why was it weak from the beginning?

- A. Germany's military government that won WWI; weak because it had too few soldiers
- B. Germany's democratic government formed in 1919; weak because many Germans blamed it for accepting the humiliating Treaty of Versailles and it inherited a devastated economy
- C. A council of Allied nations that governed Germany after WWI; weak because it lacked political support from German citizens
- D. A communist government that briefly controlled Germany; weak because it rejected democracy

14. To pay WWI reparations, the Weimar government printed large amounts of money. What was the consequence?

- A. Germany's economy quickly recovered and reparations were paid off by 1922
- B. The extra money funded massive public works projects that reduced unemployment
- C. Hyperinflation set in — by 1923, 4.2 trillion marks equaled one U.S. dollar, wiping out family savings overnight
- D. The printed money was used to build Germany's military back up secretly

15. At its worst point in 1923, how many German marks did it take to equal one U.S. dollar?

- ☐ A. About 1,000 marks — a significant but manageable devaluation
- ☐ B. About 1 million marks — serious inflation
- ☐ C. 4.2 trillion marks — rendering the currency essentially worthless
- ☐ D. About 100 marks — a modest decrease from pre-war values

16. What event in October 1929 triggered Germany's second major economic catastrophe of the Interwar Period?

- ☐ A. Germany officially defaulted on all reparation payments to the Allies
- ☐ B. The United States stock market crashed, causing American banks to immediately recall loans to Germany
- ☐ C. A severe drought destroyed Germany's agricultural production for three years
- ☐ D. Britain imposed a full trade blockade on German exports to weaken their economy

17. By 1932, the unemployment rate in Germany had reached approximately:

- ☐ A. 5% — elevated but within normal range
- ☐ B. 15% — serious but similar to other European nations
- ☐ C. 33% — nearly 1 in 3 German workers had no job
- ☐ D. 50% — half the entire German workforce was unemployed

18. What political shift did the Great Depression produce in Germany's parliament between 1930 and 1932?

- ☐ A. The Social Democrats won a majority and strengthened the Weimar Republic
- ☐ B. The Communist Party took full control of the German parliament
- ☐ C. The Nazi Party surged from 12 to 107 parliament seats as unemployment and desperation grew
- ☐ D. The Nazi Party remained a small fringe movement and lost influence during the crisis

19. Fascism, as practiced by Hitler and Mussolini, is best defined as:

- ☐ A. A democratic system that emphasizes economic equality and workers' rights
- ☐ B. A political system placing the nation above the individual, demanding loyalty to one powerful leader, using nationalism and violence to hold power while rejecting democracy as weak
- ☐ C. An economic policy focused on free markets and international trade
- ☐ D. A religious movement combining Christian values with strong national identity

20. How did the Nazi Party use propaganda to gain and maintain power?

- ☐ A. By publishing honest economic analysis that convinced Germans their policies would work
- ☐ B. By using mass rallies, radio broadcasts, films, and posters to manufacture loyalty, simplify complex problems, create enemies, and shape what millions of Germans believed
- ☐ C. By suppressing all media entirely so no political discussion could occur
- ☐ D. By funding independent newspapers to allow free debate about Nazi policies

21. Scapegoating, as used by Hitler, means:

- ☐ A. Taking responsibility for Germany's economic problems and promising specific solutions
- ☐ B. Blaming Jewish people, communists, and others for Germany's economic collapse and post-WWI humiliation — even though they were not responsible
- ☐ C. Creating a policy of economic reform to address Germany's real structural problems
- ☐ D. Building alliances with neighboring nations to share Germany's economic burden

22. Who was the first fascist dictator in Europe, and why does this matter for understanding Hitler's rise?

- ☐ A. Adolf Hitler — Germany was the first fascist state in history
- ☐ B. Francisco Franco — his Spanish Civil War victory inspired Mussolini and Hitler
- ☐ C. Benito Mussolini of Italy — he took power in 1922 and served as Hitler's direct model, proving fascism could work
- ☐ D. Joseph Stalin — his Soviet model was copied by European fascists

23. How did Hitler initially come to power in Germany in January 1933?

- ☐ A. He led a violent military coup that overthrew the Weimar government overnight
- ☐ B. He was elected by a majority of German voters in a free and fair presidential election
- ☐ C. He was legally appointed Chancellor through a political deal — conservative politicians wrongly believed they could control him
- ☐ D. He was installed by the German military, which had grown tired of the Weimar Republic

24. What was the Reichstag Fire (February 1933), and how did Hitler use it?

- ☐ A. A Nazi attack on a Jewish synagogue used to intimidate Jewish communities
- ☐ B. Germany's parliament building burned — Hitler blamed Communists and used public fear to pass emergency decrees suspending free speech, free press, and freedom of assembly, all legally
- ☐ C. A British bombing raid that Hitler used to declare war on Britain
- ☐ D. A workers' strike that Hitler violently suppressed to show his authority

25. The Enabling Act (March 1933) was significant because:

- ☐ A. It created Germany's first democratic constitution after WWI
- ☐ B. It gave Hitler the legal power to rule by decree and bypass parliament — passed by parliament itself under intimidation, meaning democracy voted to legally end itself
- ☐ C. It banned the Nazi Party from participating in future elections
- ☐ D. It gave the German military authority to arrest political opponents without a trial

---

B

Matching — Key Terms

10 ITEMS · 1 POINT EACH · 10 PTS

> *Write the letter of the matching definition on the line next to each term. Each definition is used exactly once.*

TERMS

1. MAIN _____
2. Militarism _____
3. Trench Warfare _____
4. Treaty of Versailles (1919) _____
5. Weimar Republic _____
6. Hyperinflation _____
7. Great Depression _____
8. Fascism _____
9. Reichstag Fire _____
10. Enabling Act _____

DEFINITIONS

A. The peace agreement that ended WWI by forcing Germany to accept war guilt, pay reparations, lose territory, and accept military restrictions.

B. The global economic catastrophe triggered by the U.S. stock market crash of October 1929, which devastated Germany when American banks recalled loans.

C. A March 1933 law in which Germany's parliament — under intimidation — gave Hitler the power to rule by decree, bypassing parliament entirely.

D. A political system placing the nation above the individual, demanding loyalty to one powerful leader, and rejecting democracy as weak.

E. The February 1933 burning of Germany's parliament building, which Hitler used to justify emergency decrees suspending civil liberties.

F. A system of dug-in defensive positions used on the Western Front, creating a brutal stalemate driven by industrial weapons.

G. Building up armed forces and treating military strength as a primary source of national power.

H. The four long-term causes of WWI: Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, and Nationalism.

I. Extreme rapid price increases in 1923 Germany where money lost almost all value — 4.2 trillion marks equaled one U.S. dollar.

J. Germany's democratic government formed in 1919 — born in defeat and blamed by many Germans for the post-WWI peace settlement.

C
Short Answer

3 ITEMS · 5 POINTS EACH · 15 PTS

> *Answer in 3–6 sentences each. Use specific evidence from the unit.*

1. Explain specifically how **industrialization transformed warfare** during WWI. Give at least two concrete examples of how industrial technology shaped what the war looked like for soldiers on the ground. [5 PTS]

2. Trace the cause-and-effect steps from the **Treaty of Versailles (1919)** to the conditions that produced Hitler's rise in Germany. How did a peace treaty help cause the next war? [5 PTS]

3. Hitler did not seize power through a violent military coup. Briefly explain the **four legal steps** by which he dismantled Germany's democracy between January 1933 and mid-1934. [5 PTS]

D

Essay — Synthesis

1 ESSAY · 25 PTS

> *Choose one of the two prompts below. Mark your choice by filling in the box. Then write your essay on the lines provided (and on the back if needed).*

☐ OPTION 1 · WWI

"Was World War I inevitable, or could it have been avoided?"

☐ OPTION 2 · INTERWAR

"How does a democracy collapse?"

> **Your essay must include:** a clear claim that directly answers the prompt · at least **three** specific pieces of evidence (events, dates, names, terms) · reasoning that explains how each piece of evidence supports your claim · a clear introduction and conclusion.

END OF EXAM · MR. SHARP · UNIT 5 · 2026